



Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan's
SARDAR PATEL INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY

(Autonomous)

Munshi Nagar, Andheri(W), Mumbai – 400 058.

Minutes of the 8th Governing Body Meeting

The 8th Meeting of the Board of Governors was held on 27th March 2021 at 2:30 p.m, in online mode. Following members of the Board attended the meeting:

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| 1. | Prof. Sessa Iyer | - | Chairman |
| 2. | Prof. Prachi Gharpure | - | Member, Management Nominee |
| 3. | Shri. Asif Mulla | - | Member, Management Nominee |
| 4. | Shri. Suresh Mhatre | - | Member, Management Nominee |
| 5. | Prof. V. M. Gadre | - | Member, from academia |
| 6. | Prof. S. G. Bhirud | - | Member, University Nominee |
| 7. | Prof. Y.S. Rao | - | Teaching Member |
| 8. | Prof. Surendra Rathod | - | Teaching Member |
| 9. | Prof. B.N. Chaudhari | - | Member Secretary |

Following members were granted the leave of absence:

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| 1. | Prof. Ranjan Banerjee | - | Management Nominee |
| 2. | Prof. Pramod Naik | - | Nominee of State Government |
| 3. | Prof. Manju Singh | - | UGC Nominee |
| 4. | Shri Rahul Chari | - | Member, from industry |

Principal started the meeting with a tribute to the governing body member, Late Prof. S.C. Sahasrabuddhe. He narrated how his association was helpful to the institute to inculcate the culture of academic autonomy. All members observed one minute silence and paid homage to the departed soul.

Then, Principal introduced the new members (Prof. Gadre from IITB and Rahul Chari from Phonepay) inducted with the approval from the Chairman, GB as per the UGC guidelines. Similarly, Principal introduced the new nominee of Mumbai University (Prof. S. G. Bhirud, Deputy Director, VJTI) on the Governing Body. The Chairman and the members welcomed the new members on the Governing body.

Principal gave his presentation on his perception of S.P.I.T and his tentative action plan for the S.P.I.T. He briefly presented a SWOT analysis he carried out prior to joining the institute and also presented his 5 point action plan for the next 3-5 years. This was suggested by the GB in the previous meeting. The board members appreciated it and were in sync with the observations and perception of the Principal.

Picking the point of the collaboration with external world indicated during presentation, Prof. Gadre volunteered to help with mentorship of UG/PG students and faculty on the grounds of the IIT model. At IIT he has been involved in activities where students are made partners. The activities involve students from other institutes creating massive online material. He offered

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to involve SPIT faculty and students in creating NPTEL resources. The members of the GB appreciated this. After this, with the permission of the Chair, proceedings of the regular agenda items started.

1. Confirmation of minutes and action taken report.

The minutes of the 7th meeting of Governing Body, held on 26th December 2019 as annexed in **annexure A** were circulated to all the members. These minutes are again read out by the Principal for the confirmation, and action taken (as annexed in annexure A) are narrated. Since no suggestions were received, the minutes of the 7th meeting are confirmed by the GB.

R8/01: The minutes of the 7th meeting of the Governing Body, held on 26th December 2019 are confirmed and actions taken are noted.

2. Revised Budget for 2020-21 and proposed Budget for 2021-22.

The principal briefed about the impact of the pandemic on the institute budget and presented the need for revision as the expenditure could not take place as planned due to the ongoing pandemic, and institute discontinued 17 ad-hoc faculty. The approved budget has a deficit of Rs. 60 lakhs. The revised budget has a surplus of Rs. 4.52 crores assuming SP.I.T continues to pay as per the 6th pay commission, and a surplus of R. 1.84 crores if the 7th pay is implemented by the institute, in the financial year 20-21. Similarly, he presented the budget for the year 2021-22 based on the demands from the various departments, salary expenditure (assuming 7th pay will be implemented), and average expenditure on other items. Shri Mhatre inquired about the assumption made regarding resuming the normal, in person teaching on campus and highlighted that this pandemic has huge impact on the Budget. Principal informed that the proposed budget is prepared in anticipation that the on-campus teaching will resume in July 21, i.e. from the beginning of the next academic year. Shri Mulla remarked that this is quite an optimistic view. Shri Mhatre suggested to approve the revised budget for the year 20-21 and suggested to have a quarterly budget till the classes resume.

The Principal invited the attention of the members towards the major reasons that necessitated the revision of the 2020-21 budget such as reduction of 17 ad-hoc faculty, reduction in procurement and reduction in the electricity charges etc. Shri Mulla expressed that as the faculty is getting more time, the budget on account of activities like consultancy, training, faculty development programs etc. could have been utilized fully. He also expressed his concerns regarding the FRAs response towards the surplus budget and its possible impact on the fees collection. Prof. Iyer opined that fees revision uncertainty is not only due to Covid, in fact, Maharashtra system can have more uncertainty than what covid can create. He further informed that there was large uncertainty how the fees were fixed based on 2 year earlier expenditure, divided by all students to be collected only from first year students. Thus, while discussing this budget what fees will be received depending on new courses etc. should also be considered. He suggested that the budget will have to be reviewed by taking into consideration 7th pay as well as changes due to new courses etc. He further opined that Budget should reflect

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what is planned. Prof. Prachi Gharpure pointed out that if revised budget for 20-21 shows surplus then the expenditure of 20-21 would be considered to fix fees for the

year 2022-23 by the FRA. She remarked that if we would have implemented 7th pay by then things could have been normal, but due to lesser expenditures in 2020-21, the sanctioned fees for the year of 2022-23 would be less and severely impact the finances of the institute. Principal informed about the recent appeal FRA has made to all engineering institutions regarding cutting the fees or not revising it. Prof. Gadre suggested to show provision for the implementation of the 7th Pay in this budget. Prof. Prachi Gharpure informed the board that the FRA does not accept the provisions in the budget and considers only incurred expenditure. Prof. Rathod pointed out that the budget should have been presented in the Finance Committee before the GB and suggested to relook at depreciation amount. He also pointed out that some expenses like sanitization etc. appear missing in the budget. Principal accepted this and ensured that the budget will be presented in finance committee first, before presenting to the GB. He clarified that all expenses incurred have been included, probably the heads had been titled differently.

After these discussions, the GB has approved the revised budget for the year 2020-21 and suggested to keep the approval for the budget 21-22 aside owing to several uncertainties about the fees collection, resumption of normal campus life, and clarity about the FRA policy. The GB suggested to have quarterly budget instead, till the normal life resumes and there is more clarity about the income through fees.

R8/02:- The GB approved the revised budget for the year 2020-21 and suggested to provide quarterly budget for the year 2021-22.

3. Application to AICTE for merger of the courses.

Principal briefed the GB about the undergraduate courses offered by the institute and pointed out that institute presently runs 4 undergraduate courses namely (a) Computer Engineering (b) Information Technology (c) Electronics Engineering (d) Electronics and Telecommunication Engineering. He informed about the challenges institute is facing for admissions to the Electronics Engineering course. Further he informed that a lot of laboratory infrastructure is remaining unutilized due to the compartmental approach institute has had. He pointed out that elite institutions in the country do not follow this trend. Further, at a national level, there is same curriculum and question paper for the GATE examination of Computer and IT students. Similarly, it is same for "Electronics" and "Electronics and Telecommunication" courses.

He reported that recently curriculum for both the courses in the same domain is changed significantly and a foundation in the form of common fundamental subjects is made for both the courses. The specialization or toning is attempted in the form of sequel of several elective subjects. This unification of core curriculum is praised by academic experts of the various Board of studies and Academic Council. He highlighted that the merger of the same domain courses will optimize the physical, computational,

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laboratory and human resources available with the institute and will make some laboratory and allied infrastructure available for the expansion or induction of additional courses. Shri Mhatre remarked that merging of Electronics with Electronics and Telecommunication is welcome. However, he expressed his concerns over merging of Computer and I.T courses. Prof Gadre informed the GB that IITB has Computer Science program which has both the dimensions and recommended the merger of courses as those on complementary to each other. Shri Mhatre agreed on this.

Prof. Bhirud commented that though the syllabus for Computer and IT courses needs to be different as per UOM syllabus, the courses are only shifted from one semester to the other. He also briefed about the choices of students during admissions. He suggested that the space occupied by the 2 depts can be utilized better on merger. Same infrastructure can be utilized better by increase in the intake. Thus, merging will help in expansion of the intake. Shri Mhatre raised the query on what will be done with the faculty. He raised concern on seniority among the merged departments. Suggested to tackle this sensitively. Principal informed that the institute has already a rotation policy for section heads and deans. He also pointed out that he observed the healthy environment and culture at the institute. Prof. Gadre suggested to nominate Head and Associate head and could interchange their responsibility every half year or a year. Principal appreciated this and remarked that this is unique suggestion. He agreed to implement it at the institute. Shri Mulla suggested to keep a close watch on the HR issues. Prof Gadre suggested to avoid any change in the functionary positions at the Departments.

Principal informed that due deliberations with all faculty on this proposal of merger of courses were already done, and all faculty consented for the proposed change. Prof. Iyer suggested that reconstitution of Board of Studies, Academic Council and revision of syllabus should be put in place parallelly so that people should not feel that IT has been taken out and abolished. Merger is a great opportunity not only for optimizing resources but also to encourage higher academic standards. He further pointed out to look at reconstituting the roster. Prof. Prachi Gharpure cautioned that the roster would be a big issue with University as they consider it as shutting a branch and starting a new one. Prof Bhirud pointed out that any way the institute must relook the roster due to change in cadre ratio norms of AICTE. Prof Prachi pointed out that the GB had given permission to continue with 1:15 STR. Principal assured the GB to revisit the issues of the seniority carefully and closely, cadre ratio, accreditation, professional standing etc. He informed that we need to encourage students to learn from NPTEL/MOOCs etc., we need to encourage industry internships as well. While low STR is good, faculty should not be under-utilized. After all these deliberations, all members consented for the proposed merger of the courses

R8/3(A):- The GB resolves merger of Electronics Engineering Course(60 intake) and Electronics and Telecommunication Engineering Course(60 intake) to Electronics and Telecommunication Engineering Course (120 intake) from the academic year 2021-22.

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R8/3(B):- The GB resolves merger of Information Technology Course(60 intake) and Computer Engineering Course(60 intake) to Computer Engineering Course (120 intake) from the academic year 2021-22.

4. Application to AICTE to start new undergraduate courses.

Principal narrated the need of economy for manpower in the emerging areas such as data science, machine learning, AI, robotics and automation, cyber security, Industrial IoT, mobility etc. Various surveys and reports are vectoring towards the present need of professionals in these domains and postulating the growth of these sectors. AICTE has declared the list of emerging areas and appealed the well performing institutions to introduce new courses in these domains at UG/PG level. He informed that many colleges in the state and our immediate competitors have introduced these courses from the academic year 2020-21. He pointed out that it is possible to add two more undergraduate courses within the available physical infrastructure by some rearrangements. He proposed to add two new courses at the undergraduate level.

1. B. Tech. Computer Science and Engineering (Data Science)
2. B. Tech. Computer Science and Engineering (Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning)

Prof. Gadre welcomed this proposal and suggested to look at a dual degree programs in the long run. Prof Rao pointed out the present admission challenges for M.Tech courses and also informed that institute cannot even close those programs as those are the prerequisite for a PhD program. Shri Mhatre raised the concerns that colleges who have started AI/ML courses are not getting competent faculty. He gave an example stating people who are super specialized in AI/data science are very few and charging exorbitant. They get huge salaries in industries. Thus, the whole gamut of syllabus, keeping it update is a challenge. Prof. Gadre agreed with these views and suggested to encourage young faculties and to groom them to gain these high-end skills. Shri Mhatre suggested to identify potential young faculty and train them.

Prof Rathod suggested to have one course in Robotics and AI (going towards Electronics domain) and Data Science (going towards computer Domain). Principal pointed out that being self-financed institution, we need to also look closely at the admission dynamics and social preferences towards different branches of engineering. Prof. Bhirud pointed out that Robotics will need huge investment and a new set of laboratories, while the proposed courses can be easily accommodated. Prof Gadre suggested to have a broad base approach for undergraduate courses, and systematically groom the faculty. After these deliberations, the GB resolved to permit the institute to apply to the AICTE for starting of these courses from the academic year 2021-22.

R8/4:- The GB approves the proposal to start two new undergraduate courses namely (a) B.Tech Computer Science and Engineering (AIML), and (b) B.Tech Computer Science and Engineering (Data Science) from the academic year 2021-22.

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The Institute is directed to apply for these courses to the AICTE and complete the necessary formalities with the AICTE, Mumbai University, DTE, Government of Maharashtra and the Head office of BVB.

5. 7th Pay Implementation to faculty and staff at S.P.I.T.

Principal briefed about the need of 7th pay implementation. He informed the GB that the ACITE has recommended 7th pay scale for all faculty and staff of technical institutions of the country on 1st March 2019. He informed that subsequently, Government of Maharashtra has declared the 7th pay implementation with the G. R. Dated 11th Sept. 2019. The Government and aided institutions in the State have implemented the 7th pay scales to the employees. Three well performing autonomous self-financed institutions have implemented 7th pay recommendations for their employees. He informed that institute faculty and staff are also expecting 7th pay implementation and his office has received many such requests from faculty and staff. He presented a brief review of financial status of the institute and invited attention of the members towards the surplus due to pandemic, incurred expenses and incomes, % expenditure on the salary, fees fixed by FRA for the institute, for past 5 years and requested the members to express their views and guide over this important matter.

He mentioned the sustainability of the institute in case if the tuition fees are not increased by FRA for two years. Vice Principal has reminded that there was no case in the past where the legitimate expenditure is not considered by the fees fixation committee. Prof Rao informed that as and when Institute requested fees rise with proper justification, institute got it sanctioned. He has also highlighted the possibility of a reduction in the fees due to reduced staff, maintenance bills due to lockdown. Members have expressed sooner or later we need to implement the pay recommendations. Principal explained the working of the FRA and pointed out that FRA works on the principle of reimbursement which expects institute to spend and recover the expenditure gradually in a cycle of 4 years. Prof. Gadre pointed out that without such implementation, the gap between the income and incurred expenditure will be clearly visible and will impact the future income significantly posing financial challenges 2 years down the line. Chairman suggested to wait for some time till few more institutions in Mumbai implement it. Principal, insisted to set an example to the other institutions by early implementation. He pointed out that there is no question of choice in this regard, as every AICTE approved institute is expected to implement it and have given few examples where in the self-financed colleges were forced by the judiciary to implement it. Shri Mulla sir echoed this and suggested to implement it at the earliest. After these deliberations all members have consented to the implementation of the 7th pay from 1st April 2020. However, they expressed the concerns like cash flow, risk factors involved while sanctioning the fees, by fees fixation committee and possible delay of the social welfare department in the fee's reimbursement.

The Principal has suggested three options for implementation: (A) The date of implementation in the ideal case, is 1st January 2016 as per the government declaration. (B) The Government resolution of the 7th pay is of dated 11th September 2019, hence it can be implemented from 11th Sept 2021 and arrears to the date to be paid. (C) Few

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reputed private institutes implemented it from 1st April 2020. Since the current financial year is 2020-21, majority of the members have recommended implementing it from 1st April 2020 so that the surplus of the budget of 2020-21 can be reduced and its impact on cash inflow from tuition fees in future can be arrested. It was also discussed that possibility of implementation from the date of announcement of the 7th pay by the

Government of Maharashtra is not possible as the balance sheet of 2019-20 is already audited and FRA will not take the cognizance of arrears in the fees calculations. Shri Mhatre sir reminded that this proposal being related with finance, needs to go through the finance committee. Chairman has recommended preparing an exhaustive report, revisit the financial situation and cash flow carefully and submit the implementation plan through the finance committee.

After these discussions and deliberations, all members have unanimously given a consent for 7th pay implementation from 1st April 2020.

R8/5(A):- The GB resolves to implement 7th pay to all permanent faculty and staff of the institute from 1st April 2020.

R8/5(B):-The GB resolves to pay the arrears from 1st April 2020 till date to all permanent faculty and staff of the institute.

6. New Academic Model at SPIT

Principal presented the salient features of the New Academic Model articulated at the S.P.I.T. He expressed that the institute already had few initiatives taken. He explained how this model aims at implementation of few suggestions of National Education Policy 2020. The members appreciated the model and suggested a careful implementation.

The GB noted the salient features of the new model and appreciated it and suggested a careful implementation for fulfilling the objectives.

7. Admission Statistics 2020-21

A brief statistic of admissions to undergraduate courses was presented by the Principal. The members were satisfied to note the increased response in terms of the applications received and increase in the closing percentage despite the challenges posed by the pandemic.

The GB noted the improved admission scenario for the undergraduate admissions.

8. Placement statistics for 20-21 and Internship statistics.

Principal has briefed about the placement of the students. He informed that the institute has observed growth in number of placements, quality of placement, average salary of the campus, and internship offered, despite COVID scenario. He also pointed out that

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the average CTC and the median salary of the institute is comparable to centrally funded institutions like new IITs/IIITs/NITs.

The GB noted the same and appreciated the efforts of the TPO team and faculty and staff of the institute.

9. Academic Results 2019-20

Principal informed the GB regarding challenges faced by the institute in running T-L-E processes completely in online mode. He briefed about the special policies articulated with due deliberations and its careful implementation carried out. He also presented the academic results of 2019-20.

The GB noted the results and policy articulated by the institute and expressed the satisfaction towards it.

10. NBA compliance report and NIRF ranking 2021

Principal briefed the GB about the NBA status and institute application for NIRF.

The GB noted the same.

11. Creation of new facilities during 2019-20 (Action Taken Report)

New facility and shifting the faculty rooms were approved by the GB. The work is completed in all respects, and faculty have shifted to the new faculty rooms created. The action taken report was presented to the GB.

The GB noted the same and appreciated the initiative.

12. Product Development Center (Action taken report)

A facility is created for institute students for the product development. However, due to the pandemic, its utilization to full extent could not take place. The brief report on the PDC was presented to the GB.

The GB noted the same and suggested to start utilization to the best possible extent.

13. Capital Expenditure towards compliance for Fire NOC certificate as per AICTE norms

A report about the fire system work was presented to the GB, and efforts undertaken towards obtaining fire NOC as required by AICTE were briefed. Principal informed that the work necessitated the construction of the pump house and electricity room and obtaining the building stability report. He also thanked Prof. Murdi of SPCOE for

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providing such a certificate at no cost. He informed the GB that the process to obtain the NOC will be initiated soon.

The GB noted the same and suggested to obtain the NOC as soon as possible.

14. Fee Fixation proposal for the year 2021-22

Principal briefed about the fees fixation proposal submitted by the institute to the FRA with the approval from the Chairman. He further informed the GB that the institute has positively responded to the appeal made by the FRA to retain the fees and preferred to retain the previous year fees instead of going for the fee's revision. Thus, fees fixed by FRA for the academic year 20-21 is retained for coming academic year 2021-22 by the institute.

The GB noted this and echoed the decision of Chairman.

15. Status of Mr. Hemant Vasaikar case

The Principal informed about the status of inquiry initiated against Mr. Hemant Vasaikar and the challenges posed by the pandemic. He further informed that this matter has come to closing and committee is expected to submit the report within a couple of months.

The GB noted this.

FOR RATIFICATION

16. Minutes of Academic Council held on 26th March 2021 (Will be tabled at the time of meeting).

R8/6:-The minutes of the 6th academic council held on 26th March 2021 are ratified.

17. Minutes of Equipment Procurement Committee (To be briefed by Vice-Principal, Dean R&D).

R8/7:-Minutes of Equipment Procurement Committee are ratified.

18. Procurement of Juno Software (ERP).

Principal brief about the need of a sound ERP for the institute and the process followed to identify the ERP vendor for S.P.I.T. Shri Mhatre informed that S.P.C.O.E is getting a free ERP from the Government and suggested to go for it. Prof. Chaudhari pointed out that SPCOE is getting it as it is the part of TEQIP. Further he pointed out that all four institutions on the campus, anyhow, have gone for four different products. A detailed

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note on the procurement of JUNO ERP for S.P.I.T was presented. The Chairman had approved this procurement.

R8/8:-The procurement of JUNO (ERP System for S.P.I.T) is ratified.

19. Revised Honorarium rates

Principal presented the revised honorarium rates for different experts, events. Chairman had approved these rates.

R8/9:- The revised honorarium rates are ratified.

20. Ad hoc Appointments of Professors.

Institute had given adhoc appointment to Dr. Rajendra Sawant and Dr. Radha Shankarmani with the approval from GB. Dr. Sawant's appointment was up to July 2020. Considering the needs of the institute Dr. Sawant's appointment is continued for next 2 years with Hon. Chairman's approval. Similarly, as the performance of Dr. Radha is excellent, her appointment is continued till Dec. 2021 as per GBs recommendations.

R8/10:-The Ad hoc Appointments of Dr. R.R. Sawant and Dr. Radha Shankarmani are ratified.

21. Any other item with the permission of Chair

NIL

The principal thanked all the members for their inputs and valuable suggestion, and with the permission of Chair the meeting adjourned.

**Principal
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**Chairman
DR. SESH IYER
CHAIRMAN
GOVERNING BODY
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